

1. True or Fake News? 📰

Decide if the following news story headlines are true or fake news.

News Story Headline	True	False
Gorilla learns to knit	☐	☐
Library cards given to newborn babies in Cornwall	☐	☐
Anne Frank's diary actually written by American man	☐	☐
Boy smashes 3,500-year-old vase at museum	☐	☐

2. Discuss ☁

With your partner, discuss the following:

- What do you think about these story headlines?
 - Is it easy to tell if a story is real or fake (especially if we only read it quickly)?
 - Did you have enough information to make an informed decision?
 - How might people react to each of these headlines?
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3. How Does Fake News Look? 📰

Fake news often uses shocking or **sensationalist** language to make content appear more exciting.

Fake news articles often use phrases like:

- "shocking"
- "you won't believe"
- "breaking" (*unverified*)
- "secret"
- "they don't want you to know"
- "miracle cure"
- "urgent warning"
- "exclusive"

4. Example Fake News Stories 🤔

ALIEN ARRIVAL? HUGE BLACK UFO SPOTTED IN TEXAS

Does this creepy image convince you that aliens are coming?

This picture, taken by a man on the outskirts of a small Texan town, shows a large black object gliding above the Earth.

The man said:

"It was so weird! I was driving home one evening and a dark shadow appeared over my car. I got out and saw the UFO flying right above me. I quickly managed to take a photo, but within a matter of seconds, the object turned and flew off. I couldn't quite believe it! There's no doubt that it was a UFO!"

SHOCK REVEAL: PRIME MINISTER SPENT MILLIONS OF GOVERNMENT MONEY ON LUXURY HOLIDAY AND MORE!!!

The Prime Minister of the UK has spent over £1 million of government money on a luxury villa in the Caribbean and first-class flights for a holiday!

An anonymous source revealed this yesterday, only one week before the UK election is set to take place! This is only the start; who knows what else the Prime Minister has been spending our money on!

Reflection

1. How might someone feel when reading these stories?
2. What is the motivation of these stories?
3. Do you think fake news can be harmful? Why?

Answer Key

News Story Headline	True	False
Gorilla learns to knit		
Library cards given to newborn babies in Cornwall		
Anne Frank's diary actually written by American man		
Boy smashes 3,500-year-old vase at museum		

Bibliography

Content adapted from:

- The Guardian. (2021, February 4). Fake or real? The all-new NewsWise headlines quiz! <https://www.theguardian.com/newswise/2021/feb/04/fake-or-real-headlines-quiz-newswise-2021>
- The Guardian Foundation. (n.d.). Spotting fake news (PSHE education): Lesson 5. <https://theguardianfoundation.org/programmes/newswise/schools/unit-of-work/lesson-5-spotting-fake-news-pshe-education>